

The Pointe of Caring

As she wound her way along the scenic Puget Sound, her thoughts pulled her back to “island time,” where there is no time.

The island is called Harstine, and the magical destination is at the north end of the island, “The Pointe,” as it is so aptly named.

Before allowing the memory of salty air, and majestic, mountain splendor to seep in to her thoughts; a curious tale drifted in. It was a tale that she had heard long ago, and in many different versions, but it related perfectly to the “point” of her story.

The tale goes something like this:

There was a young man, who lived in a small town. One day he decided to move to another town; so he got on the train, and rode to the next town, and pulled in to the train station. There, sitting alone, on a wooden bench, was an older man reading a newspaper. The young man interrupted him, and asked him if he lived in the town. The older man said that he did, and the young man told him that he was thinking about moving there. Before the young man could say anything else, the older man asked the young man why he wanted to move from the town he lived in. Immediately, the young man told the older man that the town was terrible, and the people were so mean to each other, and they didn’t care about each other anymore. Without hesitating, the older man told the young man that the town was just like that, and that he better get back on the train, and look for another town to move to. The young man thought that he had dodged a bullet, and thanked the older man for his advice, as he boarded the train; determined to find a nice town to move to.

A little while later, another train pulled in to the station, and another young man got off the train. He saw the older man sitting by himself, and sat down next to him, and immediately said hello, and struck up a friendly conversation. During the conversation, the young man told the older man that he was thinking about moving to the small town. Of course, the older man asked the young man what the town was like; that he had left. With sadness in his eyes; the young man began to share stories about how wonderful, and caring the people were in the town, and how much he didn’t want to leave. When the young man finished telling the older man about “his” town; the older man told him that the town was just like “his” town, and he assured the young man that he would love living there.

When she remembered that story; it caused her to smile because when she moved to The Pointe someone told her that it was, “A Caring Place,” and sixteen years later, it is still true.

It is the people, who make a place what it is. A community may be beautiful, with amenities that abound, but it is the people, who make a difference. If the people are kind to one another, and care for each other; the beauty will shine through, from the inside, out, just as love can shine through any broken heart.

It was not until she, herself, was faced with the possibility of never driving through the gate again; that put her in a tail spin. The idea of leaving a community; that cared more for others, than for themselves, tugged at her very core. Suddenly, memories of watching neighbors extending a helping hand to someone in need, without worrying about, who they were, found their way in to her heart.

She has witnessed kindness, and hospitality, from the office to the beach; to those, who cannot help themselves. Without uttering a word; a caring hand is extended with a smile, and a hand shake. Promises of, "I'll be back," are kept; true to their word.

Weekly pot lucks adorn the picnic tables with delicious goodies; just waiting to be shared. It is the hospitality, and genuine concern of the people, who make this, "The Pointe of Caring."

Sixteen years ago, we "discovered" this, "Pointe of Caring," and the compassionate people, who make it a privilege to call it, "home."

To fully appreciate a blessing; one must get close to losing it. How thankful to be a witness to the love that ties the people to this place of wonder, and beauty; to this, "Pointe of Caring."

With much gratitude,
Suzanne Bonciolini